

Word family: **okay / OK / O.K. / okayed / OK'd / okaying**

Base word: okay / OK

Part of speech: **adjective, adverb, interjection, noun, and verb**

Common spelling variants:

* **okay**

* **OK**

* **O.K.** *(less common now)*

Verb forms:

* **okay / OK**

* **okays / OKs**

* **okayed / OK'd**

* **okaying / OK'ing**

Useful patterns and extensions:

* **be okay**

* **that's okay**

* **are you okay?**

* **it's okay to...**

* **okay with something**

* **okay with someone**

* **okay by me**

* **an okay result**

* **do okay**

* **feel okay**

* **look okay**

* **give something the okay**

* **okay a plan**

* **the final okay**

* **OK, let's... **

Meaning in this passage

> He just smiled and said, "That's **okay**, we can build a better one."

Here, **That's okay** means:

it is not a serious problem; I am not angry or upset about it — 沒關係；不要緊；沒事

Leo is responding kindly after another child accidentally breaks his cardboard bridge.

He is effectively saying:

> **Don't worry. I'm not angry. We can fix the situation.**

中文翻譯：

他只是笑了笑，說：「**沒關係**，我們可以再造一座更好的。」

So the exact passage sense is:

That's okay = 沒關係；不要緊；我不介意

1. **That's okay (安慰 / 表示不介意) — 沒關係；不要緊**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> “That's **okay**, we can build a better one.”

「**沒關係**，我們可以再造一座更好的。」

Practice 2

> “I'm sorry I'm late.”

> “That's **okay**.”

「對不起，我遲到了。」

「**沒關係**。」

Practice 3

> It's **okay**. Accidents happen.

不要緊，意外總會發生。

MCQ-ready definition:

That's okay = 用來表示某件錯事或意外並不嚴重，而且自己不高興、不介意

2. **It's okay (情況沒問題) — 沒事；沒有問題**

This can describe a situation as acceptable or not serious.

Practice 1

> Don't worry. Everything is **okay**.

別擔心，一切都**沒事**。

Practice 2

> It's **okay** now; the problem has been fixed.

現在已經**沒問題了**，問題解決了。

MCQ-ready definition:

be okay = 處於沒有嚴重問題、可以接受或安全的狀態

3. **Are you okay? — 你還好嗎？你沒事吧？**

This is one of the most common interpersonal uses.

Practice 1

> You look upset. Are you **okay**?

你看起來很不開心。你**還好嗎**？

Practice 2

> She fell off her bike, so I asked if she was **okay**.

她從單車上摔下來，所以我問她是否**沒事**。

MCQ-ready definition:

Are you okay? = 詢問某人的身體、情緒或整體狀況是否沒有問題

4. **be okay (身體狀況正常) — 沒事；身體還好**

Practice 1

> He was shaken after the accident, but he was **okay**.

意外後他受到驚嚇，但身體**沒事**。

Practice 2

> The doctor checked her and said she would be **okay**.

醫生檢查後說她會**沒事的**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be okay = 身體沒有受到嚴重傷害，或健康狀況大致正常****

5. ****feel okay — 感覺還可以；身體還好****

Practice 1

> I don't feel completely **okay** today.

我今天感覺**不太舒服 / 狀態不太好**。

Practice 2

> After resting for an hour, she felt **okay** again.

休息了一個小時後，她又覺得**沒甚麼事了**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****feel okay = 感覺身體或情緒大致正常、沒有嚴重不適****

6. ****be okay emotionally — 情緒沒事；還撐得住****

Practice 1

> He said he was **okay**, but he still looked upset.

他說自己**沒事**，但看起來仍然很難過。

Practice 2

> Give her some time. She'll be **okay**.

給她一點時間吧，她會**慢慢沒事的**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be okay = 情緒上能夠應付目前情況，沒有嚴重崩潰或問題****

7. ****okay (可以接受的；尚可的) — 還可以的；過得去的****

Here, ****okay**** does not mean excellent. It means ****acceptable but not particularly good****.

Practice 1

> The film was ****okay****, but I wouldn't watch it again.

那部電影****還可以****，但我不會再看一次。

Practice 2

> The food was ****okay****, nothing special.

食物****還過得去****，沒甚麼特別。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****okay = 品質、表現或情況可以接受，但不算特別好****

8. ****an okay result / performance — 尚可的結果 / 表現****

Practice 1

> It was an ****okay result****, considering how little time we had.

考慮到我們時間很少，這個結果算是****還可以****。

Practice 2

> She gave an ****okay performance****, but she can do better.

她的表現****尚可****，但其實可以做得更好。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****okay + noun = 達到基本可接受水平，但不突出****

9. **do okay — 表現還可以；進展不錯**

Practice 1

> He did **okay** in the interview.

他面試時表現得**還可以**。

Practice 2

> Don't worry about her—she's doing **okay** at school.

別擔心她，她在學校表現**還不錯**。

MCQ-ready definition:

do okay = 表現達到可以接受或令人放心的程度

10. **look okay — 看起來沒問題 / 還可以**

Practice 1

> Does this shirt look **okay** on me?

我穿這件恤衫看起來**可以嗎**？

Practice 2

> The document looks **okay** to me.

我看這份文件**沒甚麼問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

look okay = 從外觀或初步判斷來看可以接受、沒有明顯問題

11. **sound okay — 聽起來可以；聽起來沒問題**

Practice 1

> That plan sounds **okay** to me.

那個計劃我覺得**聽起來可以**。

Practice 2

> Does seven o'clock sound **okay**?

七點鐘**可以嗎**？

MCQ-ready definition:

sound okay = 某個建議或安排聽起來可以接受

12. **It's okay to do something — 做某事是可以的**

Here, **okay** means **allowed, acceptable, or appropriate**.

Practice 1

> Is it **okay to use your phone here**?

在這裏**可以使用手機嗎**？

Practice 2

> It's **okay to ask for help** when you need it.

有需要時**尋求幫助是可以的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

it's okay to do something = 做某件事是被允許、可以接受或沒有問題的

13. **be okay with something — 接受某事；不介意某事**

Practice 1

> I'm **okay with the change**.

我**接受這個改變 / 對這個改變沒問題**。

Practice 2

> Are you **okay with meeting at eight**?

你**接受八點見面嗎**？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be okay with something = 對某個安排、決定或情況表示接受或沒有異議****

14. ****be okay with someone doing something — 不介意某人做某事****

Practice 1

> I'm ****okay with you leaving early****.

我****不介意你早點離開****。

Practice 2

> Is your manager ****okay with you working from home****?

你的經理****接受你在家工作嗎****？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be okay with someone doing something = 接受或不反對某人進行某項行動****

15. ****okay by me — 我沒問題；我同意****

Informal.

Practice 1

> “Can we leave early?”

> “That's ****okay by me****.”

「我們可以早點走嗎？」

「****我沒問題。 ****」

Practice 2

> If everyone wants pizza, that's ****okay by me****.

如果大家都想吃薄餅，****我沒意見****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****okay by me = 就我而言可以；我接受 / 不反對****

16. **Okay! (表示同意) — 好 ; 好的 ; 可以**

As an interjection, **okay** can simply signal agreement.

Practice 1

> “Meet me at six.”

> “**Okay!**”

「六點來見我。」

「**好 ! **」

Practice 2

> “Please send me the file tonight.”

> “**Okay**, I will.”

「今晚把文件傳給我。」

「**好的**，我會。」

MCQ-ready definition:

okay = 用來表示自己同意某個要求、安排或建議

17. **Okay, let's... (轉入下一步) — 好 , 那我們.....**

Here **okay** organizes conversation rather than evaluating quality.

Practice 1

> **Okay, let's begin.**

好 , 那我們開始吧。

Practice 2

> **Okay, let's move on to the next question.**

好 , 我們來看下一題吧。

MCQ-ready definition:

okay = 用來結束前一部分談話並開始下一個話題或行動

18. **Okay? (確認對方明白 / 同意) — 好嗎？明白嗎？**

Practice 1

> Be back by ten, **okay**?

十點前回來，**好嗎**？

Practice 2

> Don't touch that button, **okay**?

不要碰那個按鈕，**明白嗎**？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****okay? = 用於句尾，確認對方是否同意、明白或願意照做****

19. **Okay... (表示勉強接受 / 猶豫) — 好吧.....**

Tone matters greatly.

Practice 1

> “Can you work this weekend?”

> “**Okay...** if you really need me.”

「你這個週末可以工作嗎？」

「**好吧.....**如果你真的需要我。」

Practice 2

> “Let's try again.”

> “**Okay...**”

「我們再試一次吧。」

「**好吧.....**」

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****okay = 有時表示不太熱情、但仍勉強接受某事****

20. **Okay! (表示理解) — 明白了；知道了**

Practice 1

> “You need to press this button first.”

> “**Okay**, I understand.”

「你要先按這個按鈕。」

「**好，我明白了。**」

Practice 2

> “The train leaves from platform four.”

> “**Okay, got it.**”

「火車從四號月台開出。」

「**好，知道了。**」

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****okay = 表示自己已經理解或接收到對方提供的資訊****

21. ****okay something (批准) — 批准；同意****

As a verb.

Practice 1

> The manager ****okayed the plan****.

經理****批准了這個計劃****。

Practice 2

> The budget has been ****okayed**** by senior management.

預算已獲高層管理人員****批准****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****okay something = 正式或非正式批准某項計劃、決定或安排****

22. ****give something the okay — 批准某事****

Practice 1

> The doctor ****gave me the okay**** to start exercising again.

醫生****批准 / 同意我****重新開始運動。

Practice 2

> We're waiting for management to ****give the project the okay****.

我們正在等管理層****批准這個項目****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****give something the okay = 表示正式同意或批准某件事進行****

23. ****get the okay — 獲得批准****

Practice 1

> We can't start until we ****get the okay****.

我們要等到****獲得批准****才能開始。

Practice 2

> She finally ****got the okay**** from her doctor to travel.

她終於從醫生那裏****得到允許****去旅行。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****get the okay = 獲得進行某事所需要的批准或同意****

24. ****the final okay — 最終批准****

Practice 1

> The project still needs the ****final okay**** from the director.

這個項目仍需要董事的****最終批准****。

Practice 2

> Once we receive the ****final okay****, construction can begin.

一旦收到**最後批准**，工程就可以開始。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****the okay = 允許某事正式進行的批准****

25. ****everything is going to be okay — 一切都會沒事的****

A common reassuring expression.

Practice 1

> Don't panic. Everything is going to be ****okay****.

不要慌，一切都會****沒事的****。

Practice 2

> She hugged him and said, "You'll be ****okay****."

她抱着他說：「你會****沒事的****。」

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be okay = 情況最終會恢復正常、不會有嚴重問題****

Important distinction 1: ****That's okay vs I'm okay****

****That's okay****

Often responds to an apology or minor problem:

> "Sorry."

> "That's ****okay****."

「對不起。」

「****沒關係****。」

****I'm okay****

Describes your own condition:

> "Are you hurt?"

> "I'm **okay**."

「你受傷了嗎？」

「我**沒事**。」

Important distinction 2: **okay = acceptable, not excellent**

This is extremely important.

> The restaurant was **okay**.

usually does **not** mean:

> The restaurant was amazing.

It often means:

還可以，但不算特別好

So:

* **excellent** → 非常好

* **good** → 好

* **okay** → 還可以 / 過得去

* **poor** → 差

Context and tone can modify this, but **okay** is often deliberately moderate.

Important distinction 3: **okay vs fine**

These overlap a lot.

okay

very broad and conversational.

> I'm **okay**.

我沒事。

fine

can similarly mean well/acceptable.

> I'm **fine**.

我很好 / 我沒事。

But tone matters enormously. Both can sound genuine, neutral, or slightly reluctant depending on delivery.

Important distinction 4: **okay** vs all right / alright

These are often nearly interchangeable.

> That's **okay**.

> That's **all right**.

Both can mean:

沒關係。

Also:

> Are you **okay**?

> Are you **all right**?

Both:

你沒事吧？

All right has more spelling complexity; **okay** is especially straightforward and common.

Important distinction 5: **okay** vs acceptable

okay

informal/neutral everyday language

> This solution is **okay**.

這個解決方法還可以。

acceptable

more formal and precise

> This solution is **acceptable**.

這個解決方法可以接受。

So **acceptable** is often better in formal evaluation; **okay** is more conversational.

Important distinction 6: **okay vs safe**

They sometimes overlap but are not synonyms.

> Is the child **okay**?

asks about overall condition.

> Is the child **safe**?

asks specifically whether the child is free from danger.

Someone can be **safe** but emotionally not **okay**.

Important distinction 7: **okay with X vs okay for X**

okay with something

= accept it / not object

> I'm **okay with the plan**.

我接受這個計劃。

okay for someone

can mean suitable or permitted for that person.

> Is this medicine **okay for children**?

這種藥適合 / 可以給小孩服用嗎？

Different grammar, different focus.

Important distinction 8: **okay to do vs okay doing**

The safest standard learner pattern is:

> **It's okay to do X.**

做 X 是可以的。

For example:

> It's **okay to ask questions**.

提出問題是可以的。

With **be okay with + -ing**, the subject accepts an action:

> I'm **okay with waiting**.

我不介意等。

So:

* **It's okay to wait.** → 等是可以的

* **I'm okay with waiting.** → 我不介意等

Important distinction 9: **okay as adjective vs interjection**

Adjective

> The food was **okay**.

食物還可以。

Interjection

> **Okay**, let's go.

好，我們走吧。

These are clearly different grammatical functions.

Important distinction 10: **okay as noun vs verb**

Noun

> We got the **okay**.

我們獲得了**批准**。

Verb

> The manager **okayed** it.

經理**批准了**它。

Same general approval concept, different grammar.

Important distinction 11: **okay vs yes**

Yes directly answers a yes/no question.

> “Are you coming?”

> “**Yes.**”

Okay more often signals acceptance, compliance, or agreement:

> “Come at seven.”

> “**Okay.**”

So **okay** often means:

好的；我同意 / 我會照做

rather than simply factual **是 / 對**.

Important distinction 12: **okay can depend heavily on tone**

The written word may look identical:

> **Okay.**

But spoken tone can mean:

- * sincere agreement → **好的**
- * reluctant acceptance → **好吧**
- * irritation → **行啦 / 知道啦**
- * transition → **好，那麼.....**
- * checking understanding → **好嗎？**
- * reassurance → **沒事**

So **okay** is highly dependent on conversational context.

Family-extension note

Okay is an unusual but very useful polysemy item because its meanings are not mainly built around a physical core like **bridge**, **break**, or **light**.

Instead, it has developed around the broader concept:

acceptable / without serious problem / agreed / approved

From there, several modern uses emerge:

1. **condition**

- * I'm okay.
- * Are you okay?

2. **acceptability**

- * The result is okay.
- * It's okay to do that.

3. **lack of objection**

- * I'm okay with that.

4. **reassurance**

- * That's okay.
- * Everything will be okay.

5. **agreement / discourse**

- * Okay, let's begin.
- * Okay?

6. **approval**

- * okay a proposal
- * give something the okay

These are connected enough that we should not artificially turn every conversational tone into a completely separate dictionary meaning. But they are grammatically and pragmatically distinct enough to teach separately.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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That's okay	沒關係；不要緊	reassurance / no objection
It's okay	沒事；沒問題	acceptable condition
Are you okay?	你還好嗎？	check condition
I'm okay	我沒事 / 還好	personal state
feel okay	感覺還可以	physical/emotional state
an okay film	還可以的電影	acceptable, not excellent
do okay	表現還可以	acceptable performance
look okay	看起來沒問題	appearance seems acceptable
sound okay	聽起來可以	proposal seems acceptable
It's okay to X	做 X 是可以的	permitted/acceptable
okay with X	接受 X；不介意 X	no objection
okay by me	我沒問題	personal acceptance
Okay!	好！	agreement
Okay, let's...	好，那我們.....	discourse transition
Okay?	好嗎？明白嗎？	confirmation
**Okay... **	好吧.....	reluctant acceptance
okay a plan	批准計劃	authorize
give X the okay	批准 X	grant approval
get the okay	獲得批准	receive permission
the final okay	最終批准	formal approval
everything will be okay	一切都會沒事	reassurance about future

For your original sentence

> He just smiled and said, "That's **okay**, we can build a better one."

Here:

That's okay = 沒關係；不要緊；我不介意

Leo is not rating the broken bridge as merely “acceptable.”

He is responding to the **other child's mistake** and reassuring them:

> **The accident is not a big problem, and I'm not angry with you.**

That is why the most natural Traditional Chinese translation is:

> 「**沒關係**，我們可以再造一座更好的。」

And this little **okay** actually contributes quite a lot to Leo's characterization: instead of becoming angry or crying, he immediately accepts what happened and responds generously.